

STUDYING THE BIG BANG

Scientists at CERN (see p.49) are attempting to simulate the incredibly hot and dense conditions that followed the Big Bang using a device called the Large Hadron Collider (LHC). In a tunnel that is 17 miles (27 km) long, beams of particles are smashed together at high speeds and the products are studied. Shown here is one of the detectors, called the Compact Muon Solenoid (CMS).

